REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE Q

VOTE NO on MEASURE Q.

An elected City Clerk serves the people, not politicians. An appointed city clerk serves the city council that appointed them to the position.

If city hall mismanages something, an elected clerk has the job security to expose it. An appointed clerk that reports to the city council, making it much harder to serve as an objective whistleblower when your bosses hold your paycheck!

The argument assumes a city clerk is naturally unqualified because she is "elected." Is the "elected council also unqualified?" Election is the mechanism that translates public trust into an office. If a candidate lacks the experience to manage elections, records, agendas, and public notices, Fairfield voters can - and do - reject that candidate at the ballot box.

Measure Q claims an appointed clerk will be evaluated "regularly" and replaced "if doesn't meeting expectations." But appointment power shifts from the public to a smaller group of decision-makers at city hall.

The "this is not policymaking" point cuts both ways. Because the clerk's role is procedural and trust-based, separating it from elections invites attempts to control process rather than protect it**. Protecting democracy means keeping election administration accountable to voters not city hall.**

Fairfield needs a city clerk who serves the public and can't be separated by appointment arrangements to serve city hall.

VOTE NO on MEASURE Q.

Solano County Taxpayers Association
s/Michael T Nolan, President